

Design” (www.alistapart.com/articles/elastic/) is a good place to start.

9.1.4 Variable fixed width

This sounds like a contradictory term or oxymoron. The idea is that the layout changes automatically to best accommodate the user’s window size. For example, if the browser window is wide enough, the layout may contain three fixed-width columns. If the window width falls below a particular width, one column is seamlessly placed under another, creating a two-column layout with the entire markup still present, just reshuffled. The most reliable method is to use JavaScript to assess the window width and change the CSS of the web page as a result. Similar results can be achieved using pure CSS.

9.2 HTML Template

Let us again start by preparing a basic HTML file you can use to follow the examples in this chapter. Create a new file called `columns.html`, containing the following HTML:

```
<html>
<head>
<title>Chapter 11: Classic Layouts</title>
<link rel='stylesheet' media="screen" type='text/css'
href='columns.css' />
</head>
<body>
...column content goes here...
</body>
</html>
```

Save the file. Create `columns.css` and place the following rules into it:

```
/* Specify blanket rules for all elements */
body {
font-size:80%;
font-family:'Lucida Grande',Verdana,sans-serif;
margin:10px;
}
/* Rules for headings */
h1 {
font-size:150%;
}
```